

Employee Handbook

Company Rules, Policies & Code of Conduct

This handbook is a sample / template document. Replace the placeholder sections below with your organization's actual policies before using it in production. It is formatted as plain text for easy ingestion by text-extraction tools (e.g. PyPDFLoader).

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1. Introduction and Purpose

This handbook outlines the company's rules, policies, and expectations for all employees. It is intended to provide a clear, consistent reference for how the organization operates and what is expected of every team member, from their first day onward. All employees are required to read, understand, and comply with the policies described in this document.

- This handbook applies to all full-time, part-time, and contract employees unless otherwise stated.
- Policies may be updated from time to time; employees will be notified of material changes.
- Nothing in this handbook constitutes a contract of employment or a guarantee of continued employment.
- In case of conflict between this handbook and local labor law, local law takes precedence.

2. Employment Basics

2.1 Employment Types

Employees may be classified as full-time, part-time, temporary, or contract/consultant. Classification determines eligibility for benefits, leave, and certain company policies.

2.2 Working Hours

Standard working hours are Monday through Friday, 9:00 AM to 6:00 PM, with a one-hour lunch break, unless a different schedule is agreed upon with a manager. Employees are expected to be punctual and to record their working hours accurately using the company's attendance system.

2.3 Probation Period

New employees typically undergo a probation period of 90 days from their start date. During this period, performance and fit are evaluated by the employee's manager, and either party may end the employment relationship with shorter notice than applies after confirmation.

2.4 Remote and Hybrid Work

Employees approved for remote or hybrid work must remain reachable during core business hours, maintain a secure and professional home working environment, and attend in-person meetings when reasonably requested by their manager.

3. Code of Conduct

Employees are expected to act with integrity, professionalism, and respect in all interactions with colleagues, clients, partners, and the public.

3.1 Professional Behavior

- Treat all colleagues, clients, and visitors with courtesy and respect.
- Dress appropriately for your role and work environment (business casual unless otherwise specified).
- Avoid conflicts of interest; disclose any personal or financial interest that may influence business decisions.
- Do not use company resources, time, or position for personal gain outside authorized activities.
- Alcohol and illegal substances are prohibited on company premises and during work hours.

3.2 Use of Company Property

Company equipment, including laptops, phones, and software licenses, must be used primarily for business purposes. Employees are responsible for the care and security of any equipment issued to them and must report loss, theft, or damage immediately.

3.3 Gifts and Anti-Bribery

Employees must not offer, give, solicit, or accept bribes, kickbacks, or improper gifts in connection with company business. Reasonable, modest business courtesies (such as a working lunch) are generally acceptable but should be disclosed if there is any doubt.

4. Attendance and Leave Policy

4.1 Attendance

Employees must notify their manager as early as possible, and in any case before the start of the workday, if they will be late or absent. Repeated unexcused absences may result in disciplinary action.

4.2 Annual Leave

Full-time employees accrue annual (vacation) leave according to company policy and local law, typically starting at a minimum number of days per year that increases with tenure. Leave requests should be submitted through the HR system at least one week in advance where possible, and are subject to manager approval.

4.3 Sick Leave

Employees who are unable to work due to illness should notify their manager as soon as possible. A medical certificate may be required for absences exceeding three consecutive working days.

4.4 Public Holidays and Other Leave

Employees are entitled to all officially recognized public holidays. Additional leave categories, such as maternity/paternity leave, bereavement leave, and unpaid leave, are available in accordance with local law and company policy; consult HR for specific eligibility and duration.

5. Compensation and Benefits

5.1 Payroll

Salaries are paid on a monthly basis via direct bank transfer, on or before the last working day of each month, unless stated otherwise in the employment contract.

5.2 Overtime

Where applicable by role and local law, overtime must be pre-approved by a manager and will be compensated in accordance with company policy and statutory requirements.

5.3 Benefits

Depending on employment type and tenure, employees may be eligible for benefits such as health insurance, retirement/provident fund contributions, wellness allowances, and professional development budgets. Details are provided in individual offer letters and the benefits guide.

5.4 Expense Reimbursement

Business-related expenses must be pre-approved where required, submitted with valid receipts through the expense management system, and are typically reimbursed within 30 days of approval.

6. Workplace Health and Safety

6.1 General Safety

The company is committed to providing a safe working environment. Employees must follow all posted safety guidelines, use provided safety equipment where required, and report hazards, accidents, or near-misses to their manager or facilities team immediately.

6.2 Emergency Procedures

Employees should familiarize themselves with emergency exits, assembly points, and fire safety procedures for their office location. Fire drills may be conducted periodically.

6.3 Workplace Wellness

The company encourages a healthy work-life balance and discourages excessive overtime. Employees experiencing stress, burnout, or mental health concerns are encouraged to speak with HR or use any available employee assistance programs.

7. Information Technology and Data Security Policy

7.1 Acceptable Use

Company IT systems, email, and internet access are provided for business use. Limited, reasonable personal use is permitted provided it does not interfere with work duties, violate any policy, or consume excessive resources.

7.2 Data Protection

Employees must handle confidential, personal, and customer data responsibly and in compliance with applicable data protection laws. Data must not be shared with unauthorized parties, copied to personal devices, or removed from company systems without approval.

7.3 Password and Account Security

- Use strong, unique passwords and enable multi-factor authentication where available.
- Never share login credentials with colleagues or third parties.
- Lock your workstation whenever you step away from your desk.
- Report suspected phishing emails or security incidents to IT immediately.

7.4 Software and Licensing

Only approved, licensed software may be installed on company devices. Installation of unauthorized or pirated software is strictly prohibited.

8. Anti-Harassment and Anti-Discrimination Policy

The company maintains a zero-tolerance policy toward harassment, discrimination, and retaliation of any kind.

8.1 Prohibited Conduct

Harassment or discrimination based on race, color, religion, gender, gender identity, sexual orientation, national origin, age, disability, marital status, or any other legally protected characteristic is strictly prohibited. This includes verbal, physical, and visual conduct that creates an intimidating, hostile, or offensive work environment.

8.2 Reporting Procedure

Employees who experience or witness harassment or discrimination should report it to their manager, HR, or through the company's confidential reporting channel. All reports will be investigated promptly and treated with as much confidentiality as possible.

8.3 Non-Retaliation

Retaliation against any employee for reporting a concern in good faith, or for participating in an investigation, is strictly prohibited and will itself be treated as a serious policy violation.

9. Performance Management and Disciplinary Action

9.1 Performance Reviews

Employee performance is typically reviewed on a regular basis (e.g., annually or semi-annually) against agreed goals and competencies. Reviews inform decisions on development plans, promotions, and compensation adjustments.

9.2 Disciplinary Process

Violations of company policy may result in disciplinary action, which is generally progressive and may include: a verbal warning, a written warning, a final written warning, and termination of employment, depending on the severity and frequency of the issue. Serious misconduct (e.g., theft, violence, harassment, gross negligence) may result in immediate termination without prior warnings.

9.3 Grievance Procedure

Employees who disagree with a disciplinary decision or have a workplace grievance may raise it formally with HR for review.

10. Confidentiality, Termination, and Exit Policy

10.1 Confidentiality

Employees must protect confidential company information, trade secrets, and intellectual property both during and after their employment. Confidentiality obligations survive termination of employment.

10.2 Resignation

Employees who wish to resign should submit written notice to their manager and HR, observing the notice period specified in their employment contract (commonly 30 days for confirmed employees).

10.3 Termination by the Company

The company may terminate employment for reasons including poor performance, misconduct, redundancy, or business necessity, in accordance with the employment contract and applicable law.

10.4 Exit Process

Departing employees are required to return all company property (laptop, access cards, documents, etc.), complete a knowledge-transfer handover, and participate in an exit interview where requested.

11. Business Travel Policy

Employees who travel for business purposes are expected to act responsibly and cost-consciously while representing the company.

11.1 Booking Travel

All flights, hotels, and ground transportation for business trips should be booked through the company's approved travel channel or with prior manager approval. Economy class is standard for flights under 6 hours; exceptions require manager sign-off.

11.2 Per Diem and Meals

A daily per diem is provided to cover meals and incidental expenses while traveling, at a rate determined by destination and published in the internal travel guide. Alcohol is not reimbursable except at company-sanctioned client events.

11.3 Travel Safety

Employees traveling internationally should register their itinerary with HR, review destination safety advisories, and ensure they have appropriate travel insurance and required visas before departure.

12. Social Media and External Communications Policy

12.1 Personal Social Media Use

Employees are free to participate in social media in a personal capacity. However, employees should not disclose confidential company information, speak on behalf of the company without authorization, or post content that could reasonably be seen as harassing, discriminatory, or damaging to the company's reputation.

12.2 Media and Public Statements

Only designated spokespeople (e.g., PR, Marketing, or executive leadership) are authorized to make public statements, respond to press inquiries, or represent the company's official position in public forums. Employees who receive media inquiries should redirect them to the communications team.

12.3 Use of Company Branding

Company logos, trademarks, and branding materials may not be used in personal projects, side businesses, or external communications without written approval from Marketing or Legal.

13. Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion

The company is committed to building a diverse, equitable, and inclusive workplace where all employees can do their best work.

- Hiring, promotion, and compensation decisions are based on merit, qualifications, and performance.
- Employees are encouraged to bring their authentic selves to work and to voice ideas and concerns openly.
- Reasonable accommodations are provided for employees with disabilities in accordance with applicable law.
- The company periodically reviews its DEI practices and welcomes employee feedback through HR or anonymous channels.

14. Employee Acknowledgement

By continuing employment with the company, employees acknowledge that they have received, read, and understood this handbook, and agree to comply with the policies described within it.

14.1 Questions and Clarifications

Any questions about the policies in this handbook, or requests for clarification on how a policy applies to a specific situation, should be directed to the Human Resources department. HR maintains the authoritative, up-to-date version of all company policies referenced here.

14.2 Policy Updates

This handbook is reviewed periodically and may be updated to reflect changes in law, business needs, or company practice. The most current version is always available through the internal HR portal, and employees are responsible for staying informed of updates communicated by HR.

End of Handbook. This is a template document; consult your legal and HR teams before adopting it as an official company policy.